

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 6 4
♥ A T 6 4
♦ 6 2
♣ K J 3 2

♠ 9 5 2
♥ 2
♦ A Q T 9 8 7 5
♣ 8 7

N
W E
S

♠ K Q J 3
♥ J 9 5
♦ K 4 3
♣ Q T 6

♠ A 8 7
♥ K Q 8 7 3
♦ J
♣ A 9 5 4

West North East South

3♦

All Pass
3♦ by North

You dealt this hand.

You estimate you can win 6 ♦ tricks so you open 3♦. Everybody passes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ K J 8 5
♦ K J 9
♣ K Q 8 3

♠ 7
♥ A 6 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ A 9 7 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J T 8 6 4
♥ 9 7
♦ 6 5
♣ T 4

♠ A 5 3
♥ Q T
♦ A T 8 7 4 3
♣ J 2

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 13 points and if partner had opened with a 1 ♠ bid you'd be feeling "jumpy". But what a preemptive bidder needs from dummy are immediate winners, not points. So you pass.

Here's a pretty good tip: When partner opens with a 3-bid and you are trying to decide whether to take him to game, visualize him holding this very hand: K Q J 10 x x x of trumps and nothing in any other suit. Then base your decision on that.

West	North	East	South
		3 ♠	

All Pass

3 ♠ by East

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 4
♥ K 9 5
♦ A Q J T 4
♣ J 9 4

♠ J 9 8 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K 7



♠ K Q 6 5 2

♥ -

♦ K 6 3

♣ Q T 8 5 3

♠ A

♥ Q J T 8 7 6 3

♦ 9 7 5

♣ 6 2

You dealt this hand.

You expect your hand to produce 5 ♥ tricks and the
♠ A. So you open 3♥. Partner responds 4♥.

When you preempted 3♥ you described your hand
perfectly. You have nothing more to say except pass.

West

North

East

South

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q T 8 7 4 2

♦ 8 6 2

♣ 5

♠ Q J T 2

♥ 6

♦ K Q 5 3

♣ K 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 6

♥ J 5 3

♦ 9 4

♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 9 5 4

♥ A 9

♦ A J T 7

♣ Q J T 3

West

3♥

North

Pass

East

4♥

South

All Pass

4♥ by West

The bidding has been as shown.

No matter how much we try to reduce bridge to rules and guidelines we will never get rid of the judgement factor. With this hand you definitely have 3 fast tricks for partner. In theory he can take 6 of his own, so 3♥ should be the right contract. BUT, maybe he could ruff a ♦ in your dummy?

Fortune favors the bold so you bid 4♥ . . . and live happily ever after.